

MICHIGAN OWNER-BUILDER PERMIT KIT

Qualify for the exemption · File the permit · Pass the inspections

Project Address: _____

Township / City / Village: _____

County: _____

Enforcing Agency: _____

Owner-Builder: _____

Permit Application Date: _____

Every Michigan statute, threshold, and requirement in this kit
is cited on the page it appears on — verified August 2026.

BUILD YOUR HOUSE

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First Edition — 2026

How to Use This Kit

Five working documents, from "am I allowed to do this?" to the certificate of occupancy.

Michigan is one of the better states to build your own home in: a one-sentence licensing exemption, and permission to do your own **electrical, plumbing and mechanical** work as well — which most licensing states withhold.

What trips owner-builders up here is not the rules but **finding out who enforces them**. One statewide code is administered by **1,824 separate units of government**, and the four trades are assigned *separately* — so one parcel can be inspected by a township for one trade and by the State of Michigan for another. This kit separates what Michigan law fixes, cited here, from what your enforcing agency decides, which you fill in.

WHAT IS IN THE KIT

The five documents

	Document	What it does for you
MI.1	Owner-Builder Exemption Walkthrough	Whether you qualify, the four exemptions you rely on, and what takes them away. Read this first.
MI.2	Permit Application Checklist	What to gather before you file — the five environmental approvals, plan requirements, the sealed-plans threshold.
MI.3	Inspection Sequence	The order inspections happen in, what each one checks, and fields for dates and results.
MI.4	Where to File Directory	How to find <i>your</i> enforcing agency — per trade — and a page to write down what you confirmed.
MI.5	Forms & Documents Index	Each document you will meet: what it is, when, and from where.

HOW TO USE IT

- **Start with MI.1.** If you do not qualify for the exemption, nothing else here matters yet.
- **Then do MI.4 — before anything else practical.** Elsewhere the directory is a convenience; in Michigan it is a prerequisite.
- **Work MI.2 with a pen.** Incomplete applications are the commonest cause of delay.
- **Keep MI.3 on the job** and record every inspection as it happens.

How these facts were checked — and what this is not

Every Michigan claim here was read against its primary source in August 2026 — the Compiled Laws, the Administrative Code, and the Bureau of Construction Codes' own forms and lists — and is cited where it appears. Where enforcing agencies differ, the kit says so. Not legal advice.